

A-List

A listing of the best products in different hardware and software categories

Who's in, who's out? The competition's hot, but only the winners get to this page—a listing of the best performing hardware and software that have been tested till date in different categories.

Every month, at the Digital Media Test & Research Centre, we carry out a series of comparison tests as well as individual product

reviews. Based on these tests, the best products have been listed here (*detailed reviews in Digit-Interactive Mindware*). As different products get reviewed over the months, the top products might find themselves slipping out of the charts and replaced by the latest entrants in the market. So, keep your ears sharp and eyes open and keep yourself abreast of the latest cool products.

HARDWARE

Monitors (14 & 15-inch)

Viewsonic E53



- + OSD support
- + No message signal if power cut off
- Contact:** Roop Technologies
- Phone:** 022-6631921/2/3/4
- Fax:** 022-6103919
- Price:** Rs 7,750

Monitors (17-inch)

ViewSonic PS775

- + Very good image quality
- + Support for high resolution
- Contact:** Roop Electronics
- Phone:** 022-6175213
- + 110 MHz video bandwidth
- + Good build quality
- Fax:** 022-6103919
- Price:** Rs 24,000

Monitors (19 & 21-inch)

Samsung 955DF

- + Good build quality
- + Good colour results
- Screen clarity test fades out on corners
- Contact:** Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Ltd.
- Phone:** 011-6322517/8/9
- Fax:** 011-6932607
- Price:** Rs 31,650



Graphics card

ASUS V8200 GeForce3 Deluxe

- + Unsurpassed video quality and speed
- Needs a fast CPU to get maximum result
- Contact:** Mnemonic Systems
- Phone:** 022-8010871
- Fax:** 022-8051761
- Price:** Rs. 34,450



- + High quality sound processing

Contact: Compuage Infocom
Phone: 022-4913986
Fax: 022-4919069
Price: Rs 12,500

Motherboards

ASUS P4T

- + Fits into any ATX cabinet
- + Good feature list
- Contact:** Rashi Peripherals
- Phone:** 022-8260258
- Fax:** 022-8221012
- Price:** Rs 15,500

Processors

Pentium 4 - 1.8 GHz



- + Excellent performance.
- + Good packaging
- Contact:** Intel Asia Electronics India Pvt. Ltd.
- Phone:** 080-5550940
- Fax:** 080-5550943
- Price:** Rs 26,668

Hard disks (IDE)

IBM Deskstar 75GXP DTLA-307075 - 75GB

- + 10,000 RPM; good data transfer
- + 1 MB buffer
- Contact:** Wales Technologies
- Phone:** 022-3828100

Fax: 022-3828200

Price: Rs 17,700

CD drives

ASUS CD-S500

- + Good performance
- Slightly inferior build quality
- Contact:** Rashi Peripherals
- Phone:** 022-8260258
- Fax:** 022-8221012
- Price:** Rs 2,900

CD-RW drives

Plextor PX-W1610TA

- + High write and rewrite speed
- Contact:** Zeta Technologies
- Phone:** 022-4102277
- Fax:** 022-4102288
- Price:** Rs 13,950

DVD drives

Aopen 1640 Pro DVD

- + 16x DVD speeds; 512 KB cache
- + Good build quality
- Does not support DMA
- Contact:** Yogi Comp
- Phone:** 022-8806582
- Fax:** 022-8806582
- Price:** Rs 5,950



Speakers

Creative SoundWorks DTT2500

- + True Dolby Digital-compliant sound
- Too clumsy stand for speakers
- Contact:** Compuage Infocom
- Phone:** 022-4913986
- Fax:** 022-4919069
- Price:** Rs 24,000



Soundcards

SoundBlaster Live! Platinum 5.1

- + Dolby Digital AC-3 compliant

Laser Printers

Lexmark Optra M412

- + Good print speeds
- LCD management screen